

ATLAS - Market Intel

NEW MARKET INTEL

Saturday 16 May - 21:00 UTC macro briefing - live intel

MARKET INTEL - LIVE MACRO BRIEFING

6 major events landing in the next 6 hours
Combined risk state: 4/5 - Elevated. See operational read below.

EXPANDED TERMINOLOGY HYPERLINKS

CPI] Hawkish] Dovish] Risk-On / Risk-Off] Yield Spread] VIX] Expected D

GLOBAL MARKET MOOD & RISK STATE

Risk State 4/5 - Elevated

What **Market Mood** means right now
Markets are sensitive. A US **CPI** inflation reading at 12:30 UTC plus an ECB Lagarde speech at 14:00 UTC create a 90-minute window where surprises can move dollar pairs, gold, and US equities in a coordinated way.

What this means for trader behaviour today (dollars-first)

- Pre-event window — If your normal risk per trade is \$500 on a \$10,000 account, reduce to ~\$300 (60% of normal) for the next 6 hours. Why: bigger market swings mean wider exit-points are needed, which means more \$\$\$ at risk per setup.
- During CPI (12:30 → 12:35 UTC) — do NOT trade. Do NOT add to open positions. The first 60 seconds after the **announced result** routinely moves \$500-\$1,000 against any position on a standard \$100k EURUSD lot.
- After CPI (12:35 → 14:00 UTC) — wait for the 5-min candle close at 12:35 to read direction. Then re-size, still at 60% of normal until Lagarde finishes.
- If BOTH CPI and Lagarde surprise on the **hawkish** side: stand aside entirely for the rest of the session.

MAJOR EVENTS - NEXT 24 HOURS

17:00 UTC UK CPI (GBP) 4/5 - HIGH
17:00 UTC BOE Rate Decision (GBP) 4/5 - HIGH
12:00 UTC CPI (USD) (USD) 4/5 - HIGH
12:00 UTC Non Farm Payrolls (USD) 4/5 - HIGH
12:00 UTC ECB Rate Decision (EUR) 4/5 - HIGH

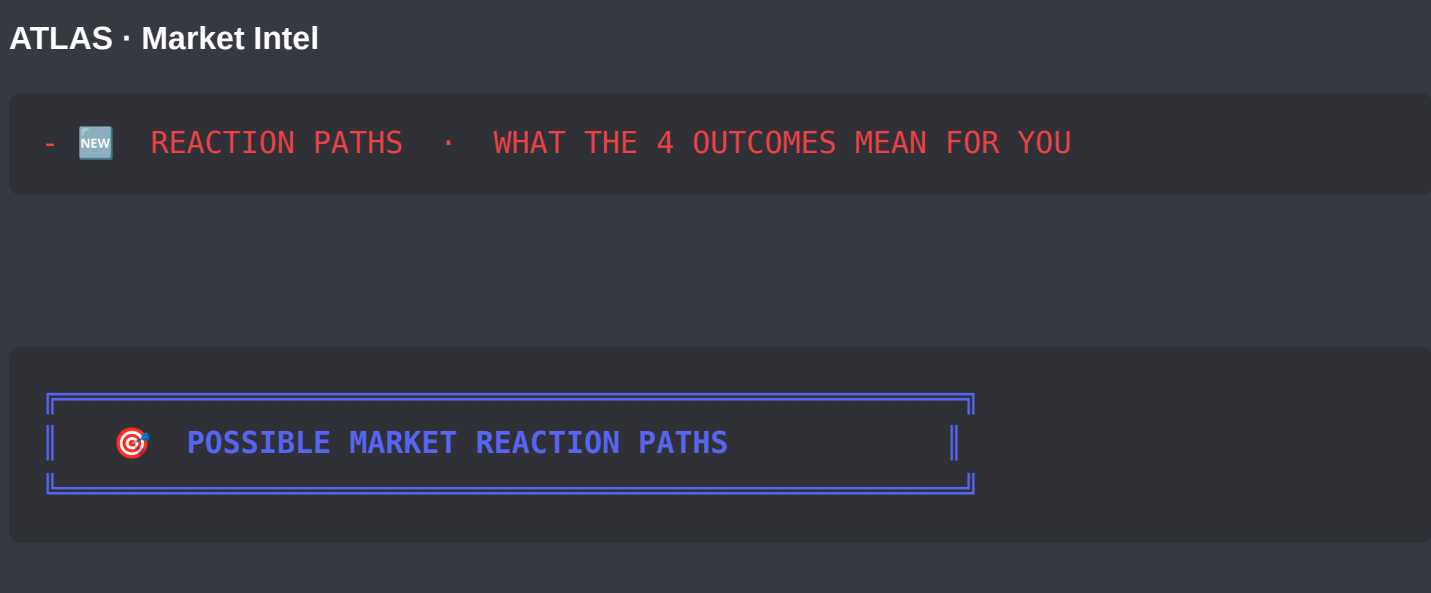
Why these events matter (plain English)

CPI is the monthly inflation reading that decides whether the Fed will keep tightening or hold steady at its next meeting. When **CPI** is **announced result** HIGHER than expected, that's **hawkish** — it pushes the US dollar up and pressures equities and gold. When it is **announced result** LOWER, that's **dovish** — the opposite happens. Lagarde's speech follows ~90 minutes later and often re-prices the euro relative to whatever direction CPI took.

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PRIMARY EVENT - UK CPI - 17:00 UTC

UK CPI - HIGH
US Consumer Price Index (the monthly inflation reading). It is the single biggest catalyst for the dollar this week. The reading decides whether the Fed leans hawkish or dovish at its next meeting.



WHEN
Today - 17:00 UTC

EVENT INTENSITY
4/5 - High

EXPECTED DURATION
Expected Duration(term-expected-duration: Intraday (next 6 hours)

AFFECTED MARKETS
DXY - EURUSD - GBPUSD - USDJPY - XAUUSD - US500 - NDX

DOLLAR IMPACT RANGE
Typical first-60-second swing range (historical CPI announcements, last 12 releases):
\$500 - \$1,000 against any position on a standard \$100k EURUSD lot.
\$1,200 - \$2,500 on 1 standard lot XAUUSD (100 oz).
\$400 - \$900 on 100 shares of a US large-cap during initial reaction.

WHAT TRADERS SHOULD WATCH - PRE / DURING / POST
BEFORE — Cut all dollar-pair positions to 60% of your normal trade size by 12:25 UTC. If your normal trade is 1 lot, begin at 0.6 lot (~\$300 risk instead of \$500). Why: pre-announcement volatility makes wider exit-points necessary, which means more \$\$\$ at risk per trade.
DURING — Do NOT trade between 12:30 and 12:35 UTC. Do NOT add to open positions. The first 60 seconds is noise — the 12:35 candle close shows the real direction.
AFTER — Wait for the 12:35 UTC 5-min candle close. Identify direction. Only re-enter on setups where price closes beyond the trigger level AND the next candle holds beyond it (the confirmed directional structure test). Still at 60% size until Lagarde finishes at ~14:30 UTC.

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REACTION PATHS - WHAT THE 4 OUTCOMES MEAN FOR YOU

POSSIBLE MARKET REACTION PATHS

Hawkish] Dovish] In-Line] Initial-Direction Reversal]

IF CPI -announced-result HIGHER than forecast - -hawkish)

Affected markets: **DXY** - EURUSD - GBPUSD - USDJPY - XAUUSD - US500

Expected behaviour:

- DXY** pushes higher — buyers pile into the dollar
- EURUSD / GBPUSD drop on dollar strength
- US indices (US500 / NDX) drop on rate-hike fears
- Gold (XAUUSD) initially drops; can recover on safe-haven flow

Dollar impact (first 30 minutes after the announcement):
Long EURUSD trades: **\$300 - \$800 drawdown** on \$100k notional
Short EURUSD trades: **\$300 - \$800 gain** on \$100k notional
Long XAUUSD trades: **\$500 - \$1,500 drawdown** on 1 lot

What you should do:
✗ Do NOT enter new long-dollar positions in the first 5 minutes — chase risk is high.
✗ Do NOT add to any short-dollar positions.
✓ Exit short-dollar positions on the 5-min close at 12:35 UTC if direction holds.
✓ After 12:35 UTC, look for **SHORT** EURUSD setups using the next Dark Horse scan as your guide.

IF CPI -announced-result LOWER than forecast - -dovish)

Affected markets: **DXY** - EURUSD - GBPUSD - US500 - XAUUSD

Expected behaviour:

- DXY** pulls back — sellers exit dollar longs
- EURUSD / GBPUSD rally on dollar weakness
- US indices rally on rate-cut optimism
- Gold rises with the broader risk-on flow

Dollar impact (first 30 minutes after the announcement):
Long EURUSD trades: **\$300 - \$800 gain** on \$100k notional
Short EURUSD trades: **\$300 - \$800 drawdown** on \$100k notional
Long XAUUSD trades: **\$500 - \$1,500 gain** on 1 lot

What you should do:
✗ Do NOT enter new short-dollar positions in the first 5 minutes.
✓ Exit long-dollar positions on the 5-min close at 12:35 UTC.
✓ After 12:35 UTC, look for **LONG** EURUSD / **LONG** XAUUSD setups using the next Dark Horse scan as your guide.

IF CPI -announced-result IN-LINE with forecast

Affected markets: light reaction across the board

Expected behaviour:

- Initial spike either side then settle. No clean directional bias.
- Markets re-focus on Lagarde at 14:00 UTC.
- Volatility drops within 15 minutes.

Dollar impact: small. \$100 - \$300 swings on \$100k EURUSD, then mean-reversion back toward pre-event level.

What you should do:
✗ Do NOT trade the initial spike — it will settle.
✓ Stand aside through 12:35 UTC. Re-read at next ATLAS scan.
✓ Re-engage normally once Lagarde delivers at 14:00 UTC.

IF -initial-direction-reversal - the first move reverses within 10 min

Plain-English: the initial direction off the announcement is faded
Volume comes IN against the first move. The 15-min close at 12:45
UTC is the real trend, not the first 60-second spike.

This happens roughly 1 in 4 CPI announcements — more often in high-volatility regimes like this one.

Expected behaviour:

- The first direction off the announcement is faded by 12:40 UTC.
- Volume comes IN against the initial move.
- The 15-min close at 12:45 UTC is the real trend.

Dollar impact (a particularly punishing circumstance):
Traders who chase the first 60 seconds: **\$800 - \$1,500 drawdown** on \$100k EURUSD before the reversal completes.

What you should do:
✗ Do NOT chase the first move under any circumstance.
✗ Do NOT add to positions on the initial direction.
✓ Wait for the 15-min candle close at 12:45 UTC.
✓ Trade only the post-12:45 direction — that's the actual signal.

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RISK ESCALATION - PRE / DURING / POST CPI

RISK ESCALATION - TIME-WINDOWED BEHAVIOUR]

Risk Escalation] Stand Aside] Position Sizing] Volatility Window]

HEALTHY - Pre-announcement window (now → 12:25 UTC)
Normal trade-management rules apply, with one change: reduce all dollar-pair positions to 60% of your normal size by 12:25. Use this window to close losing trades and tighten exit-points on winners.
Cost of staying full size into 12:30: \$200 - \$400 extra drawdown on a \$100k EURUSD position from wider whips alone.

CAUTION - T-5 minutes (12:25 → 12:30 UTC)
Close any open dollar-pair / gold / US-index positions UNLESS they are >1.5R in profit and your exit is already at break-even.
Why: at T-0, those positions face \$500 - \$1,000 first-minute swing risk on \$100k notional EURUSD.
Action: tighten exits to break-even or step aside.

DANGER - T-0 to T+5 (12:30 → 12:35 UTC)
The announcement moment. Markets routinely whip \$500 - \$1,000 against any position on \$100k EURUSD in the first 60 seconds.
Action: stand aside. Watch the 5-min candle form. Do NOT trade.

STAND ASIDE - If both CPI and Lagarde surprise hawkish
Combined surprise from both events would re-price the dollar for the rest of the session.
Expected combined post-event move: \$1,500 - \$3,000 on \$100k EURUSD over the 2-hour window after Lagarde.
Action: wait for the 15-min close AFTER Lagarde finishes (~14:30 UTC) before resuming any new trades.

RE-ENTRY - 12:35 UTC onwards
Re-read structure on the 5m chart. Match against the four reaction paths above. Act only on the setups where price closes beyond the trigger AND the next candle holds beyond it (the confirmed directional structure test).
Continue at 60% size until Lagarde finishes: return to normal sizing only after the 14:30 UTC re-read at the next ATLAS scan.

What changes this risk state

- If CPI cancels (rare): state drops to 3/5 — Active.
- If a central-bank rate decision is added: state climbs to 5/5 — Extreme.
- If Lagarde's speech is cancelled: state drops to 3/5 — Active.

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EVENT-DAY REFERENCE - THE 4 WINDOWS

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How to read an event-day chart
Every macro event has 4 windows on the chart. Pre-event is your trading window with size reduced. T-0 is the chaos window. At 12:35 UTC the noise settles and a clear direction emerges. From 12:40 onwards, the candles return to normal size and the trend is tradable.

HOW A TRADER USES THIS (CONCRETE, DOLLARS-FIRST)
Pre-event (T-5 to T-0): size at 60% of normal. Tighten exits.
T-0 (12:30 to 12:35 UTC): stand aside. Do NOT trade.
Post-settle (T+5 to T+15): re-read direction on the 12:35 close. Trade only that direction.
T-30 onwards: resume normal trading patterns.

DOLLAR CONTEXT FOR EACH WINDOW
Pre-event: \$100 - \$300 whips per 5m candle on \$100k EURUSD.
T-0 to T+5: \$500 - \$1,000 swings in 60 seconds.
Post-settle (T+5 to T+15): \$200 - \$400 per 5m candle (settling).
T+30+: back to \$50 - \$150 per 5m candle (normal).

RENDERED ATLAS EVENT CARDS — NEXT EVOLUTION
Future scans will replace the prototype chart with live ATLAS chart snapshots taken during real CPI announcements, with all four windows annotated on the actual price action.

ATLAS - Market Intel - event-day reference - prototype render

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Briefing summary

Two macro events land within 90 minutes today. Risk state is 4/5 - Elevated for the next 6 hours.

Concrete action
1 Cut all dollar-pair positions to 60% of normal size by 12:25 UTC.
2 Stand aside from 12:30 to 12:35 UTC (the T-0 window).
3 Re-read direction on the 12:35 UTC 5-minute candle close.
4 Trade only the post-settle direction at 60% size until Lagarde finishes.
5 ATLAS Market Intel next updates at 13:30 UTC with the post-CPI read.